

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 641

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to confirm the appointment of Dr. Tyler Forrest to the heritage conservation trust fund board of trustees.

WHEREAS, Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 11-7-104(a), provides for the creation of the heritage conservation trust fund board of trustees; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 11-7-104(b), provides that the governor shall appoint eleven members to the board; and

WHEREAS, Governor Bill Lee has appointed Dr. Tyler Forrest as a member of the heritage conservation trust fund board of trustees representing East Tennessee to a term that will expire on October 31, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Tyler Forrest is the President of Tennessee Wesleyan University (TWU) and a seasoned higher-education executive with experience in land management, conservation, and public service; and

WHEREAS, his leadership at TWU has been marked by strategic growth and resource stewardship; and

WHEREAS, Tyler Forrest holds a Ph.D. in Learning and Leadership, a Master of Business Administration degree, and a Bachelor of Science degree in Finance from the University of Tennessee at Chattanooga (UTC), where he also served as Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Forrest has hands-on experience with land preservation and redevelopment, having led the transformation of TWU's Kilbride Nature Sanctuary in Rhea County into a grassland sanctuary, spearheaded the redevelopment of the former Ingleside School property in Athens into a student and community recreation area, and managed a 120-

plus-acre portfolio of park-like property at UTC, balancing conservation in an urban center with institutional growth; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Forrest's commitment to conservation is complemented by his service on numerous boards, including the McMinn County Economic Development Board, Main Street Athens, and the McMinn County Library Board; he is also a member of the Kiwanis Club of Athens and has served on the boards of several organizations, including the Orange Grove Center, Partnership for Families, Children and Adults, and the Bessie Smith Cultural Center; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Tyler Forrest is a person of integrity and an active citizen whose benevolence, acumen, and strong commitment to public service have helped to enhance the well-being of this State and its citizens; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 11-7-104(b)(2), provides that each member appointed by the governor to the heritage conservation trust fund board of trustees shall be confirmed by joint resolution of the general assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that this body confirms the appointment of Dr. Tyler Forrest to the heritage conservation trust fund board of trustees for a term that will expire on October 31, 2026.